**Revision Date:**
May 1, 2022

**Background:**
Individuals may participate in the Family Stabilization (FS) program to overcome an emergency that is destabilizing their family and impairing their participation to Employment Services (ES) activities.

**Purpose:**
The purpose of this revision is to remove policy referencing the Welfare to Work 24-Month Time Clock (24-MTC). Per Assembly Bill AB 79, 24-MTC and the CalWORKs federal standards have been repealed effective May 1, 2022. AB 79 establishes the CalWORKs minimum standards as the sole set of CalWORKs hourly participation requirements throughout their time on aid.

**Policy:**
Qualifying Emergencies
CalWORKs families may participate in the FS program if the family is experiencing an emergency that interferes with employment and ES participation. Qualifying emergencies may include, but are not limited to, domestic violence, behavioral health needs, housing and utility needs, and essential vehicle repairs.

Family Eligibility
The CalWORKs Assistance Unit (AU) must include an aided individual whose ability to participate in the ES program is affected by the reported emergency. The FS request will not be approved if CalWORKs eligibility is not yet determined or expected to continue in the future month. FS participants are required to sign form FS2 *Family Stabilization Plan* listing assigned activities and necessary supportive services. Eligible family members may include:

- Noncompliant or sanctioned individuals who sign a Compliance Plan or Sanction Cure Plan
- Non-aided parents who are eligible to ES services while in a Family Reunification Plan

Participation Requirement
FS participants are not subject to the average 20/30/35 weekly hour requirements when unable to participate concurrently in ES activities. Participants must comply or demonstrate good cause for not complying with their plan to continue receiving FS services.

Eviction Prevention Services
ES participants may be eligible to housing assistance through the FS program if they are at risk of becoming homeless due to past due rent. The FS program may cover overdue rent amount(s) to avoid an eviction and rent subsidies for a minimum of three months. ES participants qualifying for subsidies will be responsible for contributing at least 30% of their income towards the rent while participating in employment-related and/or barrier removal activities leading to self-sufficiency.

Bridge Housing Assistance
The FS program may cover the costs of temporary accommodations while the homeless family is seeking permanent housing. Bridge Housing Assistance may supplement CalWORKs Temporary Homeless Assistance (THA) when insufficient to cover daily rates.

Rental Assistance

As an alternative or in addition to CalWORKs/Permanent Homeless Assistance (PHA), the FS program also provides housing assistance for ES participants who are homeless or at risk of becoming homeless due to an eviction. In alignment with PHA guidance, participants are required to show that they will be able to maintain stable housing without additional assistance. Rental assistance may cover past due rent, late fees to resolve an eviction notice, credit check fees, storage fees, and a security deposit and/or first month's rent to secure permanent housing. FS payments will only cover the AU's portion of the housing/utility expense when the AU is in a shared housing situation.

Utility Assistance

The FS program may cover past due utility bills and late fees to prevent electric, gas, water, cable, or phone service shut-off, and charges to establish new utility services (deposit, activation fee), including credit check fees.

FS participants are required to provide the supporting documentation necessary to evaluate eligibility to housing/utility assistance including, but not limited to:

- Written notice of termination/eviction or overdue rent
- Shut-off or late payment notice from the utility company
- Written statement from a shelter or shared housing provider requesting to vacate the property

Transportation Emergency Assistance (TEA)

The FS program provides assistance to cover the cost of essential vehicle repairs necessary to ensure reliable transportation to/from assigned ES activities when the participant has no access to another privately owned vehicle. The vehicle that requires repairs must be lawfully registered to the participant and/or the participant's spouse or domestic partner, and not be registered as "non-operational". Approved repairs must be completed by a licensed (California Bureau of Automotive Repair) and bonded auto repair shop, car dealership, or professional mechanic who is Automotive Service Excellence (ASE) certified. TEA may cover, but it is not limited to:

- Essential vehicle repairs not exceeding the verified vehicle value
- Regular maintenance when necessary to complete the approved vehicle repair
- Costs of making the vehicle legally drivable on the road (may include, but are not limited to tires, breaks, windshield damage repairs, vehicle registration fee)
- Car rental while the vehicle is being repaired and there is no other transportation option
- Vehicle repair estimate (if not provided free of cost or deducted from final invoice)
- Towing charges to the service provider completing the authorized vehicle repair

The FS participant is required to provide supporting documentation necessary to evaluate TEA eligibility. Verification may include:

- Current vehicle registration under the participant and/or the participant's spouse or domestic partner's name
- Two written estimates completed by different qualifying service providers

Payments

FS has a consecutive 12-month cumulative payment limit that is based on the AU size and the type of service requested. The 12-month eligibility period begins from the date the first FS payment is issued.

FS payments are issued to the service provider on behalf of the participant and may not exceed the established payment limit without County approval. The participant is responsible for the payment of any services not previously authorized by the County.

Referral Services

FS participants may be referred to Behavioral Health Services (BHS) if a need is identified and/or services are requested. Referral services for family members must be related to the barrier that is affecting the individual's successful participation and satisfactory progress in assigned ES activities.

**References:**

MPP 42-749, ACL 14-12, 14-61, 20-120

**Sunset Date:**

This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by May 31, 2025.

**Approval for Release**:

RL, 5-6-22

Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services

**Attachment A**

## CalWORKs and Employment Services (ES)
## Homeless Assistance Programs Summary

| Housing Support Program (HSP) Financial Assistance Guidelines (Enrolled in CalWORKs, Managed by ES Contractors) | | |
|---|---|---|
| Maximum financial assistance available is $20,000 per family. | | |
| | **Financial Payment Type** | **Limitations** |
| **Eviction Prevention** | • Past due rent<br>• Late fees | Maximum of 2 months |
| **Bridge Housing** | • Hotel/Motel Voucher | Up to 90 days |
| **Permanent Housing** | • Rental Deposits<br>• First/last month rent | As reasonable and within customer's ability to sustain |
| **Rental Assistance** | Monthly rental subsidy, based upon 30% - 100% of the family's current income:<br>• If the family has no income, the rent is paid 100% with HSP funds<br>• If the family has stable income, the family's rent share is anywhere from 30% to 100% of their current income, remainder is paid with HSP funds | Up to 6 months, based on need<br><br>Customer's share to increase monthly |
| **Other** | • Housing application fees<br>• Credit check fees<br>• Relocation services | As needed |
| The HSP program follows the Rapid Rehousing/Housing First model in this priority: permanent housing, rental subsidy, temporary housing. | | |

**Attachment A**

## CalWORKs and Employment Services (ES)
## Homeless Assistance Programs Summary

| ES Family Stabilization Financial Assistance Guidelines (Registered in ES. Managed by ES Contractors) | | |
|---|---|---|
| Family Stabilization has a consecutive up to 12 months payment limit that is based on the size of the CalWORKs Assistance Unit (AU) and the type of services requested. | | |
| **Financial Payment Type** | | **12-Month Cumulative Limit** |
| **Eviction Prevention** | • Past due rent<br>• Late fee | Maximum of two months |
| **Bridge Housing** | • Hotel/motel voucher<br>• Storage Fees | Up to $150 per day, up to 90 days (as needed), including taxes and fees |
| **Permanent Housing** | • Rental Deposit<br>• First and/or Last Month's Rent as required in the lease | AU size 1-4 Up to $3,500<br>AU size 5+ Up to $4,500 |

| CalWORKs Homeless Assistance (Enrolled in CalWORKs. Managed by County Family Resource Centers) |
|---|
| **Homeless Assistance is limited to once every 12 months** |
| **Temporary Homeless Assistance (Bridge Housing - hotel/motel):**<br>• $85 per day up to 16 days for an Assistance Unit size of 4<br>• Additional Assistance Unit members can get an additional $15 per day, maximum is **$145 per day |
| **Permanent Homeless Assistance:**<br>Rental assistance benefit threshold is 80% of the family's Total Monthly Household Income |